

Interviewer: Alright, so we are now recording. By the way, I forgot to mention, although syempre I want to show my face to you and I also want to show you my messy the room is para alam mo lang na I'm by myself. Although nasa labas yung husband ko, may ginagawa ring mga chores, and then my daughter. So I'm in this room and I will just blur it para hindi masyadong magulo. This is where I am right now, I'm in [City A] and 'yan. So let me begin, may iba-ibang parts itong ating interview session but I will begin with some demographics ayan 'no. And as you know from the email that I have sent, this is about romantic relationships, particularly reflecting on your own romantic relationship, as well as let's say in comparison with other romantic relationships. So 'yan, on the demographics, some of these questions I already asked but I want to ask them again for recording purposes. So, may I know how old you are?

Speaker: I am [31-35] years old.

Interviewer: And how long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker: Almost [6-10] years, uh, ano, specifically [6-10] years [6-10] months.

Interviewer: And uh, do you have children?

Speaker: Uh, wala po.

Interviewer: Okay, and then, who lives in your household? Like uh, just a number and general description of your household.

Speaker: So we are [6-10] in this household, me and my wife, we are currently living with my in-laws, her parents and uh, her sister and a brother.

Interviewer: Okay and uh, what is your main source of income?

Speaker: Uhm, right now, we are [occupation] po. So we are uh, our main source of income is uh our salary.

Interviewer: Okay and uh, just a general description of your job.

Speaker: So I am uh, a [occupation] so I've been there for almost [1-5] years now.

Interviewer: Alright okay, how would you like us to address your partner? Para when I refer to your partner later, 'yun 'yung gagamitin ko.

Speaker: Uh, by her name na lang po.

Interviewer: Okay, pwedeng by her name. Alright, sige. Anyway, ireredact naman. Okay to start off, I'd like to ask you, so I'm asking the same set of questions to you, as well as to your partner kanina same set of questions. But, just feel free of course to share, kung ano yung ready kang i-share of course. So can you tell me about your love story?

Speaker: Okay so um, almost [6-10] years ago, we met, we were then both [occupation], we met at a [location]. I was working in [City B] and the [City A] branch of the [location] then was about to open. So she and her workmates trained there in [City B]. So um, ayon, I was her [occupation] and that was [Month], they came there [Date], and then by uh, I asked her out by [Month]? Then naging kami na po by [Date].

Interviewer: So that's where you met, sa [location] and uh, kumbaga sa uh in the workplace particularly, how would you describe the development of your relationship, as part of that love story?

Speaker: Um, it was well it was not fast but I think it just uhm maybe, it just developed kasi. Well our workmates were a big factor din po doon sa uh development naming dalawa kasi they were uh, sa umpisa po, they teased us, so we just, we, we, went in the flow and eventually I asked her out, gan'on. And then uh, kasi, before that, I was single for like [6-10] years. Oo, yon. Siguro I was looking na rin po for a partner and then she came, and then gan'on. That was it.

Interviewer: Alright, so thank you for that elaboration 'no. Now I'll move on to another topic in interview, and this has something to do with the quality of relationship. So how would you compare the quality of your relationship 'no, with your wife, compared to that of your friends' relationships?

Speaker: Oh, um, sa friends ko po kasi, at least in my small circle, they are, naging friends na po kami since childhood, so until now we're like brothers. So we share, I mean, uh we're still, we're very tight, we're like family members now. And um, I'll be honest, I think I've said this sa asawa ko na there are things na I enjoy doing with my friends, and there are also things na I enjoy with my wife.

Interviewer: Right, right. So now, how about, so that's in comparison with your relationships with your friends. Now, how about the romantic relationships of your friends. So right now, the comparison is your relationship with your wife, your romantic relationship with your wife, and how it compares with the romantic relationships that your friends have. So assuming let's say na your friends do have romantic relationships as well ano. So kung ikukumpara mo yung mga relasyon nila sa mga kanilang partners, or kung may asawa din man sila, how would you compare those relationships with the one that you have?

Speaker: Siguro po the first thing, yung factor po na madaling icom-, basis po ng comparison din po is 'yung, sa anak, my close friends lahat po sila, almost all of them, lahat po sila may anak. So there are things na hindi po nila magawa na kaya naming gawin because 'yun nga, wala pa kasi kaming child, so we can, we travel a lot, we have night outs, ayun. So basically mas open, mas free kaming gumala, or uh gan'on po.

Interviewer: Sorry, alright. So I think I'm getting what you're saying 'no, so kumbaga in terms of time, the use of time. Parang 'yung iba mong friends, since they have children, they spend their time, kumbaga, in the context of, because they have, how would I say it, the time spent, is kayo, you have particularly more time with each other, that's what you're saying, and 'yun 'yung manifestation na you travel a lot, and then the nightouts. Now given this distinction between yung profile ninyo as romantic partner versus sa friends mo, in their romantic relationships, how would you compare, let's say, in terms of quality? So let's say, uh, better, or maybe uh, stronger. How would you describe, the quality can be based on how you define it. But, is it uh, better ba, or the same lang, or, or meron bang mas lesser quality, for example?

Speaker: Uhm, how do I say it... quality. Uhm, uhm kasi 'yung uhm, for us, um, we started really as, hmm. Can you cite an example paanong quality po 'yung gusto niyong--

Interviewer: It depends on how you understand let's say quality. Let's say for example, like ikaw you can set a certain criteria para masabi mong 'yung relationship high quality versus low quality, which I will also ask later pero like, like halimbawa, when you compare, quality of relationships between you and your friends' relationships. You can use your own definition of what is high quality for you or not-so high quality, pwedeng gan'un.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: But your own assessment, do you think you know, uh, if you compare, uh, how would you assess? Better?

Speaker: Uh, honest opinion po, siguro our relationship is more, is is happier, siguro kasi yung sense of humor naming dalawa, not only me but si [Name] rin. So I think that's, when I observe rin 'yung relationships of my friends, siguro there are some, na tingin ko lang po, parang boring. Pero in comparison to ours, ayun uh mapang-asar siya, gan'un din ako, then we, I mean 'yung humor din namin. Doon po sa ano na 'yun, sa area na 'yun. And then po--

Interviewer: Okay, okay. And then uh-- sorry, sorry.

Speaker: Sorry. Ano rin po 'yun, 'yung naenjoy din po namin, kaya factor din po 'yung wala pa kaming anak, we get to uhm spend time na kaming dalawa lang po. So 'yun 'yung naenjoy namin ngayon, na wala pa kaming child, like uh, unlike my friends na hindi sila makalabas when we, for example, we, we, umuwi po kami sa province po, where they are based also right now. Hindi sila makalabas so kami po 'yung pumupunta sa kanila, gan'un po.

Interviewer: Okay. In a way, what you're saying here is, mayrong major effect yung pagkakaroon din ng anak, or wala pang anak. At the same time, there's also these indicators na you find your relationship, your current relationship as happier, kasi there's that, that fun part, that sense of humor, and the sense that you are able to kumbaga, be together more often than other couples. Sabi mo nga, you spend more time together. Right, so thank you for that. Now, this time the comparison is between this relationship you have now, compared to let's say these relationships in the past. So if I may ask, how many romantic partners have you had in the past?

Speaker: Uhm, maybe [1-5] or [1-5]? Or [1-5] po.

Interviewer: Okay, right. So, given this number, kumbaga meron kang comparison na pwedeng tingnan, how would you now compare the quality, so still quality, based on your definition, how would you compare the quality of this current relationship to that of your previous relationships?

Speaker: Uhm, when I was younger po kasi, may factor din po yung parang, uh, I would describe myself po as ah, uh hopeless romantic n'ung ng ng, younger years ko. Masyado akong idealistic so, uh, I mean my wife knows this na um, medyo na-, n'ung naging kami na po, medyo nabawasan po 'yung pagsusurprise ko sa kanya. I don't know kasi I, siguro I, Nawala na 'yung gan'ung feeling ko n'ung bata ako. Maybe because contented na rin po ako, so, but I think, in uh, when we talk about quality po, maybe ano, I don't know mas happy naman po ako ngayon. Kasi everything's I mean, we're married, and n'ung time na 'yung wala pang kasiguraduhan. Siyempre I was a student, maybe factor din po 'yung ano, 'yung status, 'yung pagkakaroon ng work, mga gan'un po.

Interviewer: Okay, so if let's say, just like my question earlier, so in terms of quality, you said naman na there's contented, mas happy, and therefore in terms of quality, how would you rate it, 'no, like would it be a better, is this a higher quality relationship versus the previous relationship you've had or is this almost the same lang? Okay. So uh, how would you assess that?

Speaker: Ayun po, like I've said earlier, I gave our relationship a 10 kasi I mean we are, of course, in a romantic relationship, we have fights but we settle it. We are more open. There's more maturity in it. Unlike the previous relationships na we're just maybe, naïve, at time? Pero right now, kasal na tayo so we have to settle this, we have to talk about this, and especially na mag-asawa na tayo, especially when we have a fight na it's about something na serious, we, we, we settle it.

Interviewer: Okay, so thank you for that. So now, still on relationship quality. General question, so for you what makes a relationship high quality? Ayan no, I just want to probe a bit on that. So in general, not only in your current relationship, but in general, for you what is the criteria for a high quality relationship versus a low quality relationship?

Speaker: Sa high quality po siguro, for me, I mean 'yung maturity, 'yung openness, openness to uhm compromise, and then ayun po. 'Yun po talaga 'yung nakikita ko. Versus 'yung pag low quality, yung kabaligtaran niya, siguro selfishness, ganon po.

Interviewer: Now um, uh, for you, given all these things na you said, halimbawa, openness, maturity, and the idea that you need to compromise with each other, versus you know 'yung pagiging selfish or self-centered sa relationship. Um, given all these questi-, answers that you gave, what do you think would be the most important? Kung ikaw 'yung halimbawa, just to rank them, kung, everything has to, ano 'yung hindi talaga pwedeng mawala? Para masabi sa isang relationship ito 'yung pinakamahalaga.

Speaker: Um, right now po kasi, 'yung uh, well, uh, sa relationship po namin ni [Partner's Name], dito ko po nakilala si Lord. So the most important thing right now for me is yung, nakasentro talaga kay Lord yung relationship.

Interviewer: Alright, thank you for that. So kumbaga, quite different from your previous answers here, may pumapasok na, kumbaga 'yung faith no, Christian faith particularly, I suppose, or correct me if I'm wrong. But what you're saying is in any relationship, what's more important is to make sure that in that relationship, the center of the relationship is the Lord. So uh thank you. Now, moving on, let's look on some, your thoughts on the conceptualization on love, no. So for you, parang ano 'to, parang slambook, kung naabutan mo man 'yung mga slambook, for you what is love, ayan. How would you define love?

Speaker: Love, uh, is when you don't- selflessness siguro para sa akin. You don't only think of yourself parang gan'on, of course you involve your partner or your- this is love po in general or romantic love--?

Interviewer: Well, for the context of this study, we're really looking at romantic love.

Speaker: Okay, sig po. Ayun po, 'yung selflessness and uh, two words, maturity and selflessness.

Interviewer: So um, if you were to ask, if I were to ask you, sorry, how important is love in this relationship? So for example, you defined love as selflessness and that, uh you know, there's this certain maturity and the partner's involved, how important is love in the relationship?

Speaker: Um, like I've said earlier, very important sa akin 'yung foundation si Christ, so uh, Christ himself is love. 'Yung I mean, it's well, it's a command, first and foremost, and uh, it's also one of, for me, one of the foundations of a functioning, a good relationship.

Interviewer: Right, right. What you're saying is love is truly important, I suppose in that, knowing that you know, the concept of love being Christ and also, and therefore the foundation of any relationship. Kumbaga that's how important love, as defined by let's say, in Christian faith, is important. Functioning, you said 'no, kumbaga, if without Christ, is that what you're saying? T here's no relationship to talk about--

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: So thank you for clarifying. So now, moving on to, still the motion of love, how do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker: Of course uh, through her actions, through her words, ayon uh, I mean, sometimes I just feel it then without uh, just the, yung uh her ways, gan'un po.

Interviewer: Uhum, uhum, right. Can you cite for example a situation where, let's say, this particular situation where you really felt, you said it's something that you feel right. So can you cite an instance, if you don't mind noh, on how these actions or words you were able to as manifestations of love, paano mo nafeel 'yun?

Speaker: Uhm, kasi my partner is maalaga siya. And uh, siguro she's very expressive sa uhm, sa words, sa actions, she likes hugging, I mean she's very sweet po sa words niya.

Interviewer: Uhum, uhum. Maalaga and sweet sa words, and as you said, meron ding physical manifestations nung love na 'yun like hugging, ganyan, okay. So thank you for that. And of course, in any relationship, as you said earlier, hindi naman laging pleasant 'yung, meron kayong fights or something, or conflicts perhaps, or even challenges in general. So, as you reflect in your relationship, what do you say are, what would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker: Uhm, siguro po sa, sa ugali naming dalawa. Like, for example, for me, haha, very military-ish like po ako, parang gusto ko I, I wake up early, ayaw ko po ng nalalate, gusto ko po malinis lahat kasi I learned that from my, uh, or nakita ko po yun sa parents ko, uh specifically my mom. So when there are things na, ganito may kaunting dumi, naiirita na po ako. And then um, I mean yung differences po namin na gan'un. Maybe siguro sa family rin po like kasi na-observe ko rin po kasi we are living with her family, so may mga pare-pareho po silang ugali. Or, yung traits na medyo for me is uh, nakaka-off po, parang ganun po. Pero slowly po, I uh, naintindihan ko naman po siya. And of course, she does what I tell her and the other way around din po. Gan'un.

Interviewer: So there's some differences like you say, in terms of sa ugali, ano nga bang ugali, like certain traits that we, uh you have or certain traits that your partner might have, 'no. And if, let me just probe a bit on that, this is not to assume that you fight ano, but in case that you do, let's say you have big or small fights man 'yan no, um, uh, what would be uh, if you can cite an example you

know, that you wish to share of course, like uh, are there instances na, first and foremost, are there any kinds of fight or small fights or big fights or baka naman you know, petty fights or something. And then uh, what is the nature of these fights?

Speaker: Uh, yes. First of all, I admit na uh, mabilis din po kasi uminit yung ulo ko, and then 'yun yung sinabi ko po kanina, na there are things na ayoko and about being maayos, how do you say that--

Interviewer: Organization, orderly.

Speaker: Organization, 'yun po. Sa like, simple things din po, doon po ako medyo na, I mean, 'yun din po, 'yun po mostly 'yung nagiging cause ng fights namin. Pero yeah, uh, I admit po na mainitin, umiinit din po ulo ko so and uh, sige po 'yun po muna.

Interviewer: Okay, and in relation to that, so halimbawa differences in ugali and uh sometimes, temper, differences in things that uh, um, what you want and let's say, halimbawa 'yung ayos nga 'no. So given that example, how do you resolve? Kung may mga gan'un mang konting alitan o small fights nang matatawag, how would you, how do you resolve these?

Speaker: Uh, actually po, sometimes po, sometimes we, tinutulog na lang po namin and the next day, okay na po kami. So we are not the type of couple na we settle things before we go to sleep. Minsan nangyayari na lang po sa amin na bati na kami, parang we'll look at each other and then we smile na lang gan'un na okay na tayo na gan'un. Hindi kami masyado na, or for me maybe, siguro sa end ko po 'yun na I'm not that confrontational. 'Yun, gan'on po.

Interviewer: Okay, yeah. So in relation to these, mga challenges ng relationship, may mga nabanggit na, na like sometimes you're not that confrontational, eh sometimes you don't directly settle the issue and then you just, you know, parang based on what you're saying, parang you just let things pass muna and then maaayos siya nang parang mas natural, I suppose 'no, like you said nga, you just smile and then, okay na. But aside from these things, are there other ways by which you can maintain, or by which you maintain your relationship with [Partner's Name]? So ano 'yung mga ways mo para mamaintain 'yung relationship mo?

Speaker: Ayun po so after nga po na masettle in nang natural way, ayun we talk, we agree na ganito dapat yung gawin natin. So uh, and then she expresses kung ano yung mali yung ginawa ko, ano mga yung dapat iimprove, especially yung ano nga, yung temper ko. So we talk things po after.

Interviewer: So more on, yung may conversation kayo about it, to maintain the relationship. So um, now I will ask you a question on, yung tinatawag natin na occupational latitude. So what do we mean by this, this is 'yung idea na the relationship helps you achieve your goals or it helps, it helps regulate your day-to-day functioning, and yun nga, the attribution is because of your relationship with your partner. So, given this notion of occupational latitude, would you say that your relationship is good for you?

Speaker: Yes po. Kasi first of all nga, yung number one po yung foundation namin si Christ, she is a factor why uhm naging believer po ako. And then, yun, the things that she does uhm, siguro I, uhm, there are things na I'm aware of na, like maybe habits na hindi ko matanggal pero po, or dahil po sa

kanya, nababawasan or natatanggal. Like yung temper ko rin po, it's not like, it's unlike before, I flare up easily. Ngayon, po because of her, kalma ka lang, mas, ayun po.

Interviewer: So actually, 'yung sagot mo na 'yan quite related sa next question I will have. But you can add more to this. So the next question is about you no, yung reflection mo about yourself because of the relationship. So did this relationship change you and if yes, in what way?

Speaker: Yes, yes, very much po,. Kasi yun po, iaano ko pa rin po yung, pagiging Christian ko. Especially po, dati, I was, I drink a lot, I have vices, nagmumura po ako. Pero right now, I'm a little bit calmer right now, lalo sa temper ko, gan'un, ayun po.

Interviewer: Alright, thank you. On the reverse naman, so reflecting on [Partner's Name] um, personality, or you know, general attributes niya, do you think, um, your partner, changed also? During this relationship?

Speaker: Yes ma'am. Kasi, especially po maybe sa pagiging, maybe sa part ng disiplina. Like, uh, nung ano pa po kami, di pa po kami kasal, mabagal talaga siya kumilos, late siyang gumising, mga ganun po. Then I encourage her na mas maging disiplinado, especially sa health, especially to exercise. Then siya naman po, she encourages me to eat healthy food. Mga gan'un po.

Interviewer: Hmm, okay. So 'yan thank you for that. So in a way, correct me if I'm wrong, dito sa inyong relationship, there are certain changes that happened between, there are certain changes that happened to you, as well as to [Partner's Name]. But how would you consider these changes are these um, how would you assess these changes? Is it like, are you the same person as before no, because of the uh, you know, are you the same or totally different person as before, and the same with [Partner's Name]? Is she a totally different person before as compared to now?

Speaker: Uh, we changed for the better po. I think I can say that for her din po muna, she changed for the better. Based on our conversations na rin po.

Interviewer: Okay, thank you for that. So the next topic is on, feelings of safety in the relationship. Do you feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker: Opo, I'm, I feel safe, I feel secure with her.

Interviewer: And could you elaborate the reasons for that?

Speaker: Um, siguro rin po because of magaling siyang, magaling siya sa pera. Magaling siyang mag-isip, well, she's very aggressive po sa, to invest, mga gan'ung bagay po.

Interviewer: So that adds to the feeling of security. Is this more on financial security?

Speaker: Financial security din po, opo.

Interviewer: Okay, right so thank you for that. Now I'll be sharing my screen no. Kasi 'yung question ko, quite similar to the one I asked you in the email. So teka lang, hanapin ko lang 'yung file. So ito muna, I have two questions muna, from this file. Ayan, so ito yung first question. And then there's a rating scale as well, from 1-9. So, how would you respond to this question, my partner usually really listens to me. From 1 to 9, 1 being not at all true to 9 completely true.

Speaker: Um, I'll give it uh, 7 po.

Interviewer: Okay, so very true. Ayan, okay. I will do a follow up question on that later but let's answer this one first. So the next question is, my partner usually is responsive to my needs. Again from 1 to 9, not at all true yung 1, and completely true yung 9. How would you respond--

Speaker: Uh, 8.

Interviewer: 8, right. Between very true to completely true. Now as a follow up question for the first item, so let's go back to that. Here you answered 7, so can you expound why you answered 7?

Speaker: Maybe because siguro sa factor na, I don't know, makakalimutin siya, or sa dami ng bagay na ginagawa niya, or parang 'yun maybe factor po 'yun.

Interviewer: 'Yung forgetfulness, and as you said, baka meron siyang maraming naiisip din, and that's true no, minsan we forget things already. Ayan, alright. Now, you answered 7, i-probe lang kita ng kaunti pa, why not 6, for example, which is closer to 7, or why not 8 which is a bit higher than 7?

Speaker: Kasi po I feel her sincerity na, 'pag uh, she tries really na, she'll do, pero nga po but because of some things, sometimes she's like, kasi she does a lot in her work, she does a lot in her studies, ayun po siguro. Pero ;yung sincerity po, nandoon. Pero hindi ko po siya mabigyan ng 8 or 9 kasi nga po may mga things na ayun, she forgets.

Interviewer: Oo, oo, okay. So thank you for the clarification. Now for the second item, ang sagot mo dito ay 8 naman, which is between very true nga and completely true. So the same questions, the same follow up question for this item, so why did you answer 8 for this item and again, why not 7 which is a little bit lower but still very true or not 9.

Speaker: Um, I can't give po kasi 'yung perfect na score dito sa tanong na 'to. Kasi well we both have to also cater to our needs, and then but generally po, she's always responsive, she gives whatever she can, she is supportive, whatever I want, 'yung sa mga ginagawa ko po, especially po sa mga hilig kong gawin, ayun po, she's very supportive po, pero I can't give po yung 9 kasi ayun po, parang I don't know, parang selfish po ba, I, I, I can't, 'di ko po ma--

Interviewer: Right, it's okay. So ayan, at least you were able to say naman na andun 'yung, it's kumbaga, what I'm getting is, you find it, actually mataas naman kasi 'yung 8 din, hindi nga lang yung andung sagad na sagad na 9. But of course at the same time, what you said there is, you also need to address your own needs diba? And therefore, you respond to your partner's needs but you also need to respond to your own, uh, needs. And sometimes, syempre, uh, okay lang din naman. So thank you for that. Now stop share muna ako, and then I'll ask the same question I asked earlier. But this time I have some questions which is quite sensitive for some, but I hope you don't mind if I ask. Of course, in any relationship, such as of course, among married couples also, like you ano, there's also physical intimacy involved no. So feel free to say if this is too sensitive for you to share, but I also wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. Two questions lang naman, one is about the frequency of physical intimacy, particularly for example, uh, sex 'no, and then the other question is the satisfaction in your uh, sex life. Ayan. So if you can just elaborate a bit on that but uh, your call.

Speaker: Okay po, uhm. During the start of our relationship, mas, of course, mas intimate po kami. Yung sa frequency, mas, ganon po, lagi naman po. Pero po right now maybe, siguro factor din po sometimes yung, I mean for my side, factor din po kasi siguro yung sa work or yung sa ginagawa ko, like sa mga activities ko kaya hindi yung intim-, sa sex, I mean hindi na siya gan'on ka-frequent. So, uh, we talk about it. Especially right now, we are trying to have a child, so ayon, mas uh, mas nagiging frequent na po ulit 'yung uh, sex.

Interviewer: And uh, in terms of satisfaction, ayan, uh, how would you, walang scale eh no, pero general uh, ano lang, general description of your satisfaction with your physical intimacy and sex life in general.

Speaker: Right now po, I'm very satisfied with my partner naman po. I don't know pero I'm not the type of guy din naman po na I'm not, hindi naman po ako mahilig sa, like some guys na, uh, they are, uh nambababae, or gan'un po. And, there's one thing po that I like to add po sa intimacy. I think na, there's a big uhm, there's a big difference po nung, nung mas bata po ako sa rela-, comparing n'ung sa mas bata po ako sa relationship namin ngayon. Like when I was younger po, very uh, touchy po ako, mas, mas, I like hugging. Pero ngayon, parang napansin ko rin po sa sarili ko na, I'm minsan, minsan nawawala 'yung ganon. I think she knows that too, and we are talking about it naman.

Interviewer: Thank you, thank you for sharing that. Okay. So those are just the questions I have about physical intimacy in general. Now, we're nearing the end of the interview session, but let me share, uh, another, this is actually the same question I asked earlier, but you know for recording purposes let me just share my screen again. Ayan, right. So this one. Right, hindi iyan 'yun. Next siguro. So uh, I asked this in the email, ano, but I want to ask your answer again. I want to hear your answer again. So how satisfied are you with your relationship, so from complete dissatisfied to completely satisfied.

Speaker: I'm completely satisfied po.

Interviewer: Alright, okay, so uh, if you answered completely satisfied, let's just go to the next slide here. So the same scale I gave also in the email, so I'd like to ask that again. How would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship, from a scale of 0 to 10.

Speaker: I'll give it a 10 po.

Interviewer: Right, 10, so if you answered 10, ayan so the same question naman I asked earlier doon sa first two items. So you answered 10, and why not for example why not 9 which is also near 10?

Speaker: Um, maybe we've come to a point na naintindihan na po namin that uh, fights are included in a relationship, that uhm, we understand we are at a level na we really understand each other na, na this is a part of the relationship, 'yung pag-aaway, 'yung pagiging ano, i don't know, maybe we're on the, sa lahat ng factors na, sorry po, hindi ko ma-express, ng factors ng relationship, maybe parang we uh, we don't really have to uh, paano ba 'yon uh, like for example 'yung fighting, we don't really have to magtagal sa gan'ung estado--

Interviewer: State.

Speaker: Opo, gan'un. I mean, and then, uh, big factor din po kasi yung we have bible studies so we get reminded of what we should do, so kung may mangyari man na ganito, it's just a phase of the relationship and at least we always talk whatever na, uh, decisions, and whatever yung sa lahat ng nangyari sa relationship namin, pinag-uusapan naman namin and uh, she corrects me, I correct her. So it's very mutual naman po.

Interviewer: So thank you for clarifying no, the reason for the answer na, giving the numeric response of 10. I think na-elaborate mo naman like particularly when you shared that, uh, correct me if I'm wrong when you're saying na, there are fights but you don't have to linger on these fights.

Speaker: Yes, linger po.

Interviewer: And then parang nakatulong nga 'yung mga bible devotion, or studies that you have together no, in a way para nga sa pag-address noh, I mean, I suppose para 'yung anchor doon sa sinasabi mong pagiging completely satisfied. 'Yan, alright. So actually we are done with the interview but I just like to go over noh, some, not all your answers of course, but just to highlight, highlight lang ng mga sagot mo, then feel free to correct me, or add something later no, kung may gusto ka pang idagdag or icorrect sa mga natak down ko dito sa aking notes.

Interviewer: Right, so in terms of the context of your love story, you said that you met in the workplace noh, so kumbaga yun yung pinaka-where you met. And then yung relationship developed quite well, uh, a month after so parang may gano'n no, you mentioned na you started dating and then you became a couple months after you met. Right, so in terms of the quality of your relationship, compared to let's say your friends' romantic relationships, you said that having a child is a major distinction between your relationship and the romantic relationship of your friends, particularly because you were able to you know, in terms of the time spent together noh, mas mataas compared to let's say other couples who have children. Um, you mentioned that uh, you have things that they cannot do and you can still do, like travel a lot no, go on night outs, and in a sense you said that in a way your relationship seems happier no, compared to other relationships. As far as comparing your relationship with your past or previous relationships, you said that this particular relationship is actually more open and there's more maturity, there's more contentment you said, before kasi nga you're more like a hopeless romantic noh, or idealistic, something like that. Pero ngayon mas ano na, mas andoon yung contentment no, at mas masaya ka na rin. 'Yan, no. And then in terms of let's say, yung quality, what describes a high quality relationship versus a low quality, you mentioned these keywords, the importance of maturity, openness and compromise, while for a low quality relationship, sabi mo, isang indicator nun is yung selfishness. But for you, the most important thing in a relationship is putting the Lord as the center of the relationship, 'yan.

Interviewer: In defining what is love, you said that love is when you don't think of yourself anymore, but you show more of selflessness and maturity. And, love, sabi mo nga, the foundation of love is Christ, given that Christ is love, and that love, therefore, is very important in a relationship. It helps in the functioning, I think you said something like that, like functioning of the relationship. You know your partner loves you through her actions and her words that you actually feel it kasi maalaga siya, and even with words, she has this sweet, sabi mo nga, sweet siya sa kanyang words, no. As far as challenges are concerned, you said that uh, the difference is mainly, ugali, like, halimbawa, and tracing it also sa differences in family upbringing siguro no. And in terms of fights, you said that

somehow siguro pwedeng ma-trace yung fights na 'yun, kasi, you own it also noh, dahil maybe it's because of your temper, na, yung pagiging minsan mabilis uminit yung ulo. But at the same time you said that, when you have this misunderstandings or fights, you're the type of person who's not really confrontational, and so therefore the problem gets settled, 'no, on its own, parang gan'on, you just let things be. And then, when you wake up the following morning, na-settle na. And then you know, you smile at each other and things get settled that way. But, at the same time, you also mentioned na, 'pag natapos na 'tong mga fights na 'to, or conflicts no, within the relationship, you two are still able to talk things out. Ayan no, and you did say na, also, na this relationship is good for you, sabi mo nga. At isang factor doon is because she was a major instrument for you to become a believer in Christ.

Interviewer: And you also said na, yes both of you changed because of the relationship. Ikaw, particularly, you also mentioned again, yung temper mo, where now, you are a bit more calmer. And of course, yung vices before, are no longer here now. As far as your partner is concerned, sabi mo, may change rin, in terms of discipline on her part, and in general, thought you both changed for before, you both changed for the better. And you also affirmed na you feel safe and secure in the relationship. You also saw how she can be quite aggressive when it comes to investments but you see that as a more of a positive trait about her, right. As far as your answers to the questions kanina are concerned, you answered 7, for the question on, whether your partner really listens to you, and you said na 7 kasi, although you see na may sincerity on her part, meron pa rin talaga yung pagiging forgetful niya, ayun, maybe because of too much work or too much things on her mind. And on the question on your partner being usually responsive to your needs, you answered 8. Kasi nga sabi mo rin, na syempre, meron ka ring ina-address na needs para sa sarili mo at hindi lang sa partner. Ayan, no, what else? In terms of sex and physical intimacy, you said that there's satisfaction naman, although you noted na in terms of frequency, mas madalas ang frequency noon, compared to ngayon, where both of you are much older. Ayan, right. And then, as far as being satisfied in the relationship is concerned, you said that you are completely satisfied and you're giving it a numeric response of 10. And, you did mention here the importance of devotions or Bible study that make your relationship more satisfying. Ayan, so is there anything else you'd like to add, so I tried to wrap it up quickly, is there something else you'd like to add or correct if I made some wrong points there.

Speaker: Um, okay naman na po ma'am. But, it made me realize on some things lang.

Interviewer: Yah, okay, but you have nothing else to add.

Speaker: Yes, wala naman.

Interviewer: Okay, I hope the realizations are positive.

Speaker: Yes, very positive.

Interviewer: Okay, so thank you for that. On the technical part of the interview session, I want to talk to you about how we will handle the data, ano, it's also in the consent form, but we can also discuss it now. As a research project, as ethically transparent as possible, and so we wanted to know which data sharing option you are most comfortable with. Option 1 is that transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you. So kumbaga, sabi ko sa iyo kanina, sa transcription part, may mga redacted portions, like 'yung very specific na names, places, if you said something, in the interview session na very specific. Right, because the idea is, if you will read

again the consent form no, meron kasi doong data sharing tayong ginagawa sa mga researches now, we make it available to other researchers, kasi part ng transparency 'yun, para alam nila no, na we're not deceiving people, creating all these data lang. That's option 1, portions lang ang ishashare. Option 2 is basically, itong buong usapan natin will be transcribed no, and that will be, that will still mean na portions that are quite sensitive and personal or overly identifying details will be of course, removed. It will be anonymized, in other words. So in this option, andon pa rin naman 'yung chance na someone who knows you well can piece together the details in the transcript and narrow down who among their colleagues they believe it is. Ayan, no sensitive information will be shared. So, of the two options, which do you prefer, yung portions of the transcript, option 1, or option 2, which is the complete transcript that we have in this recording.

Speaker: Yung complete nalang po, 'yung option 2 na lang po.

Interviewer: Okay. Thank you, I'll note it, option number two. And then of course, I also have that in the consent form, but you know we're recording here via Zoom na, of course we can see each other's faces, but I have to upload a recording, so do you prefer na may video or audio na lang?

Speaker: Uhm, siges po, I'm good with the video.

Interviewer: Alright, okay, siges. So thank you for that. So thank you so much again, syempre, for participating in this study. I really appreciate yung pagbibigay mo ng oras, kayong dalawa ni [Partner's Name] noh, thank you for sharing your love story, no, to me. Of course I'm a complete stranger but thank you also for really, helping me, he nominating you no, as a potential couple. After this, I will prepare an email, of course, to formally thank you, and there's also a link to that email that will lead you to a survey, of course voluntary pa rin naman 'yun. Ayan, so I'll send that to you, later siguro tonight, I'll prepare the email. Ayan, so thank you so much, anything, if you have other concerns, the results can be made available to you, and to [Partner's Name], noh, later. You just have to tell us na if you wish to receive the results. But, hindi pa naman very soon, dahil multi-country study siya, hindi agad-agad makukuha yung results. But of course, if you wish to find out the results later, of course, we can also share that with you. Just feel free to contact me or Miguel, which is the project leader. You can also contact him.

Speaker: Yes ma'am. Thank you rin po for this opportunity to be a part of your research, and we hope for uh, its success po.

Interviewer: Thank you so much! Alright, have a good evening, have a good long weekend, bye.